Discussion Guide: AI in the Classroom

Honest AI conversations with students of any learning stage.

Made for the Ones Who Move Different.

— EJOSHI —

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SECTION 01

WHY THIS GUIDE EXISTS

Your students are already using AI. The only question is whether they're using it thoughtfully or reflexively.

This guide is for teachers who want to bring AI into the classroom calmly. Not as a policy fight. Not as a tech demo. As a real, honest conversation — the kind that builds the AI literacy a school year actually needs.

Inside: a four-question framework you can use across any subject. Discussion prompts by student learning stage. Teaching moves that work in a real classroom. A short section on grading honestly when AI is in the room. What to say when the conversation stalls. And the one conversation worth having once a year.

The whole guide fits in about fifteen minutes of reading. You'll get more out of it if you adapt it to your room as you go — the prompts here are starters, not scripts.

Who this is for

- Teachers who want to talk about AI without it becoming a fight.
- Teachers whose students are already using AI and want to teach them how to use it well.
- Teachers whose students don't know what AI is yet, and want a calm introduction.
- Anyone bringing AI into a learning environment for the first time.

> **The Ejoshi promise.** Always honest. Built for everyone, not just the people who already know. Free to access. No paywall. No gatekeeping. The future shouldn't be locked behind a paywall.

SECTION 02

THE FOUR-QUESTIONS FRAMEWORK

Four questions you can teach in fifteen minutes. They work across any subject and any learning stage. Read the question, the why behind it, and the way you might introduce it to a class.

Question 1 — What is it?

The understanding question. What does this AI tool actually do? How does it work, in general terms? What is it NOT?

How to introduce it: *"Before we use this thing, let's talk about what it actually is. AI is not magic. It's not a search engine. It's a model that finishes patterns. Let me show you what that means…"*

Why this question is first: students who skip it use AI thinking it knows things, when really it predicts things. That mismatch creates most of the trouble people get into with AI.

Question 2 — Who made it, and why?

The power question. Who built this? What do they benefit from? What decisions were baked in? What voices weren't in the room when those decisions got made?

How to introduce it: *"Every tool we use was made by people. Those people had to make choices — what to include, what to leave out, what to optimize for. Let's look at the choices behind this one."*

Why this question matters: it's the most important habit a student can carry into the rest of their life. Not just about AI. About every tool, every product, every platform they'll ever use.

Question 3 — What can go wrong?

The risk question. Where does this tool fail? Who does it fail for? What kinds of mistakes does it make? What's the cost of those mistakes?

How to introduce it: *"Everything fails sometimes. The honest question is: when this fails, what kind of failure is it, and who pays the cost?"*

Why this question matters: AI fails confidently. Students who don't expect failure will be the ones most surprised by it. Students who do expect it stay sharper.

Question 4 — What do I do with it?

The agency question. How do I use this in a way that serves my goals, instead of letting it shape my thinking for me?

How to introduce it: *"The most important question is the last one — what are YOU going to do with this thing? Not what it does to you. What you do with it. That's the difference between using a tool and being* *used by one."*

Why this question matters: the whole frame of the conversation lands on this question. The other three feed into it. The student who can answer Question 4 honestly has the AI literacy that schools should be aiming for.

> **The pattern.** What is it? Who made it? What can go wrong? What do I do with it? Four questions you can run across any tool — AI, social media, news source, recommendation algorithm. The framework travels.

Why four questions and not more

You could ask twenty. Most curricula do. Four is the right number because it's the number students can hold in their head walking out of a class — and the number they can ask themselves silently when they sit down with a new tool for the first time. Four also matches the way most students think: what is this, who's behind it, what can go wrong, and what do I do? You're not teaching a framework. You're teaching the four questions a curious mind asks automatically. The framework is just naming the moves they could already do.

SECTION 03

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS BY LEARNING STAGE

Three sets — choose what fits your class. None of these have right answers. The point is the conversation.

For students new to AI

- *Have you used AI before? What did you use it for?*
- *What do you think AI is? What do you think it is not?*
- *If AI helped you write something, who gets the credit for it?*
- *What's the difference between AI helping you and AI doing it for you?*
- *Where in your life would AI be useful? Where would it be wrong to use?*

What you're listening for: the student's working assumption about what AI is. Most of them think it's smarter than it is. The conversation starts from that misconception.

For students with some AI experience

- *When is it okay to use AI for schoolwork? Where is the line?*
- *Have you ever caught AI being wrong? What did you do about it?*
- *If AI can do this assignment for you, what is the assignment actually for?*
- *What's a kind of work that AI makes you better at? What's a kind it makes you worse at?*
- *If a friend cheated on a test with AI, would you say anything?*

What you're listening for: where their thinking has stalled. Most kids at this stage have habits but haven't examined them. The questions are the examination.

For deeper discussions

- *Whose knowledge, values, and perspectives are baked into these tools?*
- *Who doesn't have access to AI tools, and what does that mean over time?*
- *What happens to a human skill when we outsource the practice to AI?*
- *What's something AI should never be used for in education? Why?*
- *In ten years, what's a skill you wish you'd learned without AI?*

What you're listening for: nuance. At this stage, students can hold competing ideas at once — AI is useful AND has downsides; AI can help me AND can shape me. That ability to hold both is the goal.

> **A note.** You don't need to cover all five in any set. One good question, fifteen minutes of honest discussion, is worth more than five questions skimmed past.

What if students push back?

They will. Some will say AI isn't a big deal. Some will say everything you're teaching them is already obvious. Some will roll eyes. That pushback is itself information. The student saying "I already know how to use AI" usually means they've used it twice and gotten lucky. Don't argue. Show them the verification challenge from Section 04. Let the tool teach them what your argument couldn't.

SECTION 04

TEACHING MOVES THAT WORK

Three classroom moves with the script. Use them as you'd use any teaching strategy — adapt to your room.

Move 1 — Show, don't tell

Open the AI tool on the board. In front of the class. Ask it a question. Show the output. Then ask the class: *"Is this right? How would we check?"*

Why this works: most AI literacy curricula talk about AI without using it. Students learn more from watching you catch the AI being wrong in real time than from any explanation.

Move 2 — Compare outputs

Same question. Different students. Different prompts. Compare the answers. Ask: *"What changed? Why? Which one is more useful for this situation?"*

Why this works: shows that the prompt shapes the answer. Most students learn this faster from watching three of their classmates' prompts than from hearing a teacher explain it.

Move 3 — The verification challenge

Give the class an AI-generated text with three factual errors embedded. Their job: find all three. They can work in groups. They can use any tool they want — including the AI itself.

Why this works: turns AI literacy from theory into a game. The students who win the challenge become the ones who teach their classmates next time.

> **The pattern.** Don't lecture about AI. Let the class catch it being interesting and being wrong. That's what they'll remember.

Move 4 — The "ask the AI to be wrong" exercise

A surprising one. Ask the AI to argue against itself. *"Give me three reasons this answer might be wrong."* Watch the AI critique its own output. Students often see, for the first time, that the confident voice is a style choice — not a guarantee of accuracy. The same tool that just said "X is true" will, when asked, list three reasons X might not be. That contradiction is the lesson.

Why this works: it teaches a habit students can use the rest of their lives, with any source. Don't trust confidence. Ask for the counter-argument. The answer that survives both sides is the one worth keeping.

SECTION 05

GRADING AND CREDIT IN AN AI-FLUENT CLASS

This is the parking-lot question every teacher asks but few curricula answer. Here's the honest take.

Grade the process, not the product

If you grade what the student turned in, AI has already won. If you grade what they learned — and you can show that's what you're grading — the work changes shape.

A practical move: ask students to explain back what they wrote. Out loud. In their own words. If they can't, the AI did the work. If they can, they did. Grade the explanation as much as the artifact.

Be explicit about your rules

The single biggest source of "AI cheating" is unclear expectations. Tell your students, before the assignment: "AI is allowed for [these parts]. AI is not allowed for [these parts]. If you used AI, write a one-sentence note at the top explaining how."

The note matters. Not because you'll always read it. Because writing it forces the student to think about how they actually used the tool. That's the lesson.

When you suspect AI without proof

Don't go on a hunt. AI-detection tools are unreliable. Calling out a student you can't prove cheated damages trust without teaching anything. The better move: bring them in for a calm conversation. Ask them to walk you through the work. Listen. The conversation, not the verdict, is where the learning happens.

Designing assignments AI can't shortcut

The longer-term move: write assignments that AI can't do alone. The pattern is the same across subjects — anything that requires the student's specific voice, specific experience, or specific local context. A reflection on a class discussion from last week. An interview with a person they know. A response that builds on a comment a classmate made. An analysis of something the student created earlier in the year.

These are harder to write than generic prompts. They're also impossible for AI to shortcut without leaving obvious seams. The work to redesign the assignment, once, pays back across every student who turns it in.

> **What this section isn't.** It isn't a policy. It's a stance. The policy is yours to write. The stance is: teach what AI changes, grade what learning is.

SECTION 06

WHAT TO SAY WHEN THE ROOM GOES QUIET

Sometimes the conversation stalls. The students sit there. The silence stretches. Here's what to say next.

The two re-entry questions that reliably restart it:

1. *"What's the most honest answer to this question — even if it's complicated?"* 2. *"What would your friend say to this, if they were sitting here?"*

Why they work: the first one gives permission to be uncertain. The second one removes the pressure of speaking for yourself. Both lower the social cost of contributing. The conversation comes back.

If neither works, that's information too. The silence might mean the question was too big, too abstract, or too close to something the students don't yet have language for. Try a smaller, more concrete version. Or move on. Not every question needs an answer in the same lesson.

> **The honest catch.** Students don't go quiet because they don't care. They go quiet because they're calibrating. Give them the space and a smaller foothold.

SECTION 07

THE CONVERSATION TO HAVE ONCE A YEAR

If you have one full AI conversation with your students this year — the big one, the one you save the long block of class time for — make it this one:

> *"What kind of student do you want to be when AI can do most of the easy work for you?"*

That's the whole question. Not "should you use AI." Not "is AI cheating." Not "will AI take your job." The question that matters underneath all of those is: *who are you trying to become, in a world where the easy work is automated?*

The honest answer, from any student, at any age, is what you're actually teaching them when you bring AI into the classroom calmly. They're not learning to use a tool. They're learning to be a person in a world where the tool is everywhere.

That's the work this whole guide is pointing at. Quiet, practical, repeatable. A teacher who can host that conversation, once a year, is doing more for AI literacy than any policy or any course module ever will.

A note for the teacher who feels behind

If you're reading this kit and feeling like you should have been talking about AI with your students six months ago — same. Most teachers are in that position. The honest catch: the conversation that matters isn't about catching up. It's about starting the right kind of conversation now and continuing it for the rest of the year. Students don't need a teacher who knows everything about AI. They need a teacher who's willing to ask the real questions with them. You already are. That's the qualification.

Start with one question. Save the discussions that worked. Come back when you need them.

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